

THE THREE PILLARS OF SPEAKING

Week 1+

VOICE

HOW you sound

V

- + Volume
- + Pace
- + Clarity
- + Expression

BODY

HOW you look

B

- + Posture
- + Gestures
- + Eye Contact
- + Space

MIND

HOW you think

M

- + Confidence
- + Preparation
- + Focus
- + Courage

FEELING FACES

Expression

:D

HAPPY

joyful, cheerful

: (

SAD

upset, down

>: (

ANGRY

frustrated, mad

D:

SCARED

nervous, afraid

:O

SURPRISED

amazed, shocked

=D

EXCITED

thrilled, pumped

:|

BORED

flat, uninterested

:)

CALM

relaxed, peaceful

:}

PROUD

confident, strong

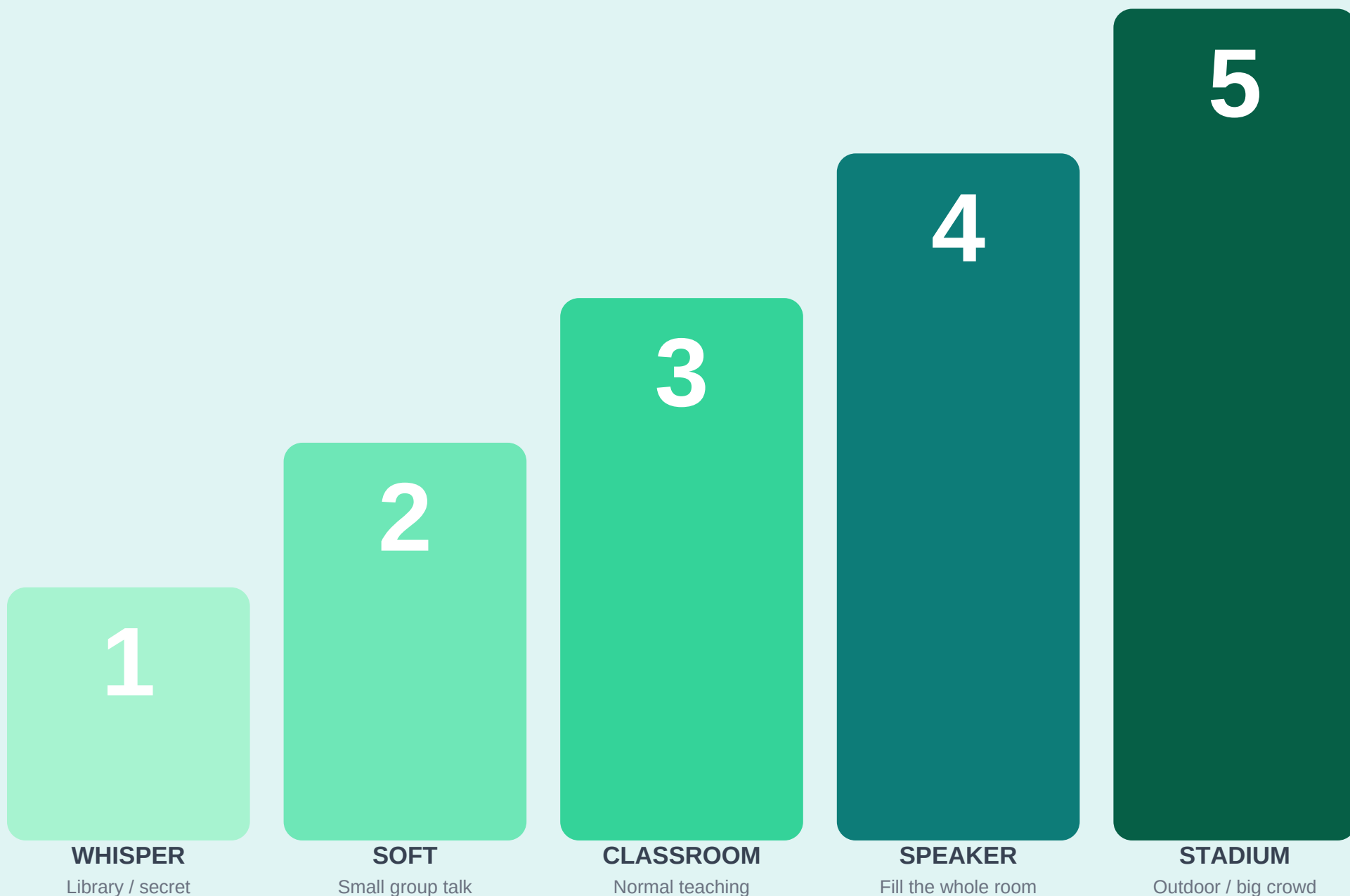
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CURIOUS

wondering, puzzled

VOICE DIAL — 5 Levels

Voice Pillar



5-POINT BODY CHECK

Body Pillar

1

FEET

Hip-width apart, flat on the floor. No rocking or weight-shifting.

2

HANDS

Visible and relaxed at your sides. No pockets, no crossing, no fidgeting.

3

SPINE

Tall and straight. Imagine a string pulling the top of your head toward the ceiling.

4

SHOULDERS

Back and down. Not hunched forward or raised up to your ears.

5

CHIN

Level with the floor. Not tilted up (arrogant) or down (hiding).

THE 3 HOOK TYPES

Voice Pillar

ASK A QUESTION

EXAMPLE:

"Have you ever been so scared you forgot what to say?"

EXAMPLE:

"What would you do if you could fly for one day?"

WHY IT WORKS:

Makes audience think.
Draws them in personally.

WOW FACT

EXAMPLE:

"Sharks existed before trees."

EXAMPLE:

"You make 35,000 decisions every single day."

WHY IT WORKS:

Surprises the audience.
Creates instant curiosity.

TINY STORY

EXAMPLE:

"Last Tuesday I almost burned down the kitchen..."

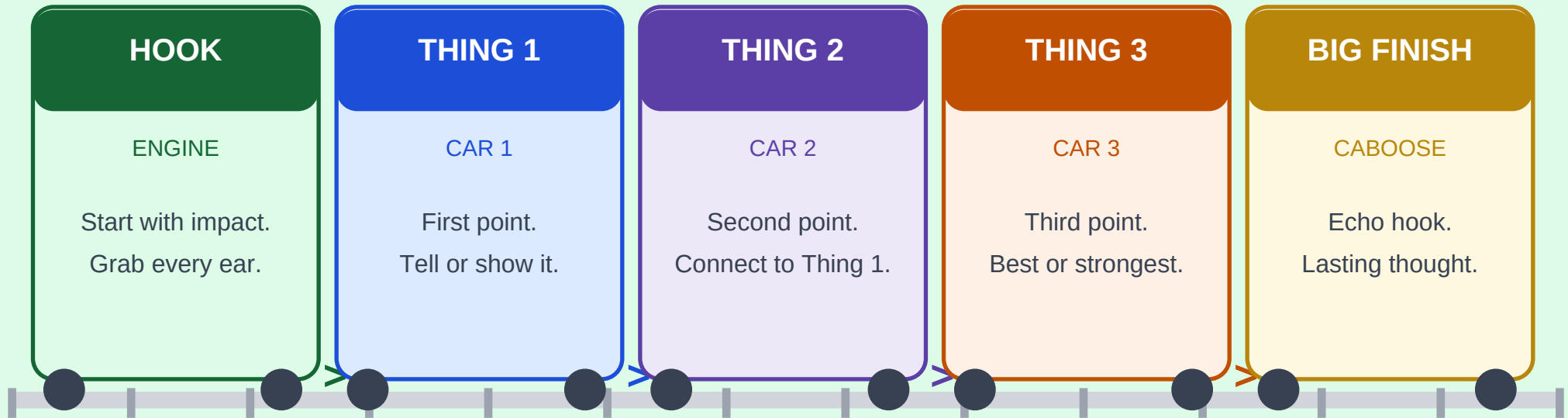
EXAMPLE:

"She looked at me and said three words I'll never forget."

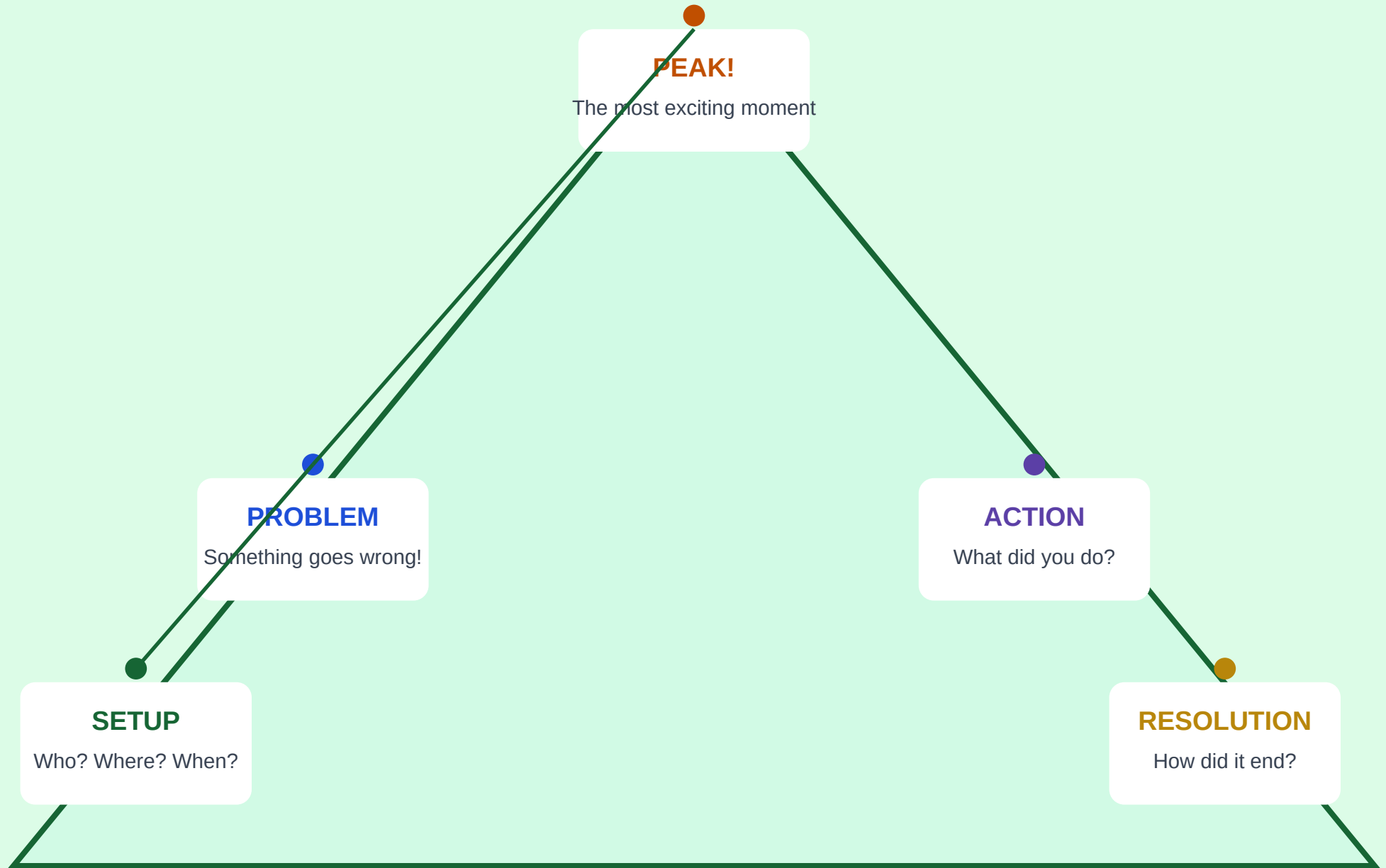
WHY IT WORKS:

Creates suspense.
Pulls them into your world.

THE THREE-PART TRAIN



STORY MOUNTAIN



FEEDBACK SANDWICH

Evaluation

TOP BREAD

COMPLIMENT

Say ONE specific thing that worked.

"I loved how you looked right at us when you said the funniest part."

FILLING

SUGGESTION

Give ONE clear, kind thing to try next time.

"Next time, try slowing down during your Hook — it will land even better."

BOTTOM BREAD

ENCOURAGEMENT

End with something they can look forward to.

"I cannot wait to see this speech again. You are really getting it!"

PRE-SPEECH RITUAL

Showcase

1

BRAVE BREATH

Breathe IN for 4 counts.

HOLD for 4 counts.

Breathe OUT for 6 counts.

Repeat if needed.

2

POWER POSE

Feet wide apart.

Hands on hips or raised.

Head up, chin level.

Hold for 10 seconds.

3

ANCHOR PHRASE

Say inside your head:

"I know my speech."

"I have practised."

"I am ready."

4

WALK & BEGIN

Walk to the front.

Pause. Look at 3 people.

Take a breath.

Then — begin.

Find Your Voice

Voice Pillar

THREE PILLARS

Voice + Body + Mind — introduce today

WARM-UP GAME

Name + Feeling Toss (circle)

STRUCTURE

My name / I love / I get nervous when

STAR OF DAY

Student who showed the most courage

The Voice Dial

Voice Pillar

VOICE DIAL

Levels 1-5 — hold card up during speeches

WARM-UP GAME

Volume Machine (call levels, class responds)

STRUCTURE

Animal — Amazing Fact 1, 2, 3

WATCH FOR

Level 4 during speeches — signal silently

Stand Like a Speaker

Body Pillar**BODY CHECK**

5 points: feet / hands / spine / shoulders / chin

WARM-UP GAME

Statue Gallery (freeze in emotion poses)

STRUCTURE

Superhero — power — action — why you chose them

WATCH FOR

Class does body check silently before each speaker

Eye Contact

Body Pillar

TECHNIQUE

3-Person Sweep: Left — Middle — Right

WARM-UP GAME

Eye Contact Tennis (silent passing)

STRUCTURE

Favourite season — 2 reasons

WATCH FOR

Assign 3 audience anchors per speaker

The Hook

Voice Pillar

HOOK TYPES

Ask / Wow Fact / Tiny Story — introduce card

WARM-UP GAME

Hook or No Hook (class votes which grabs them)

STRUCTURE

Hook + Rule Change + 2 reasons + close

FEEDBACK

Comment on Hook only this week

The Three Things

Mind Pillar

TRAIN PARTS

Hook — Thing 1 — Thing 2 — Thing 3 — Big Finish

WARM-UP GAME

Story Train (one sentence per person around circle)

STRUCTURE

Favourite day — 3 things that happened

AUDIENCE JOB

Hold up fingers 1-2-3 as each car is delivered

Feelings & Expression

Voice Pillar

FOCUS

Match voice + face to the emotion of the content

WARM-UP GAME

Emotion Translator (same sentence, 5 emotions)

STRUCTURE

Proud moment — what happened — how you felt

AUDIENCE JOB

Rate expressiveness 1-5 after each speech

Confidence & Nerves

Mind Pillar

BRAVE BREATH

IN 4 / HOLD 4 / OUT 6 — before every speaker

WARM-UP

Brave Breathing x3 + Power Pose 10 seconds

REFRAME

Nervous = excited — same body, new story

STRUCTURE

Hard thing I learned — how — breakthrough — lesson

STORY MOUNTAIN

Setup — Problem — Action — Resolution

IN MEDIAS RES

Start in the middle of the action — not the beginning

WARM-UP GAME

One-Sentence Story (4 people, 4 parts of arc)

STRUCTURE

Something went wrong — what happened — what I learned

Humorous Speech

Voice Pillar

TIMING

Say the funny thing — then PAUSE — let them laugh

RULE OF THREE

1, 2... and surprising 3rd

WARM-UP

Comedian's Pause demo (with vs. without pause)

AWARD

Best comedic pause — student re-delivers that moment

The Big Finish

CONCLUSION

Echo Hook + Restate Topic + Lasting Impression

NO WEAK ENDINGS

"That's all" or trailing off = not allowed

WARM-UP GAME

Stuck Landing — freeze after last word, hold silence

FEEDBACK FOCUS

Rating the landing strength 1-5

Putting It All Together

All Pillar

FULL STRUCTURE

Hook — 3 Things — Big Finish (Speech Sandwich)

FEEDBACK

One Star + One Wish per speech

BRAVE BREATH

x1 before each speaker — routine building

PREVIEW

Mention Showcase in 3 weeks — students share topics

Inform vs. Persuade

INFORM

Goal: teach. Language: facts, definitions, explanations

PERSUADE

Goal: convince. Language: argue, evidence, call to action

WARM-UP GAME

Same Topic Two Speeches — class identifies difference

COMMITMENT

Each student declares Showcase mode: inform or persuade

Review & Polish

All Pillar

FEEDBACK SANDWICH

Compliment (bread) — Suggestion (filling) — Encourage (bread)

REHEARSAL DAY

Full showcase speech — timed (aim 60-90 sec)

ONE FIX

Each student writes the ONE thing they will improve

PRACTISE

Say it in mirror at home — tell your family

Showcase Part 1

All Pillar

PRE-SPEECH RITUAL

Brave Breath — Pose — Anchor — Walk — Pause — Begin

STUDENT MC

Introduce each speaker: name + grade + topic

FORMAT

Speech (60-90 sec) + 1-2 audience questions + compliment

PACE

~4 min per speaker — roughly half the class today

Showcase + Celebration

All Pillar

GROWTH ARC

"In Week 1 I could not... but now I can..."

SELF-EVALUATION

C-R-C on yourself: what I did well / will work on

CERTIFICATES

Certified SpeakUp Speaker — Grades 1-2, Fall 2026

CLOSING

Loudest send-off of the semester: I AM A SPEAKER!